

VARSHA SATHYANARAYANAN

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PROFILE

NIFT-trained merchandiser with relevant experience in fashion buying, category management, and P&L ownership across retail and e-commerce. Built a women's casualwear category from zero, delivering ₹3.5L revenue in 2 months and improving margins from 22% to 35% through vendor negotiation and assortment optimization.

Proven ability to manage 200+ SKUs, improve sell-through by 15%, and expand assortments from 5 to 25+ subcategories by onboarding 12+ vendors. Experienced in PO/PI coordination, PLM workflows, and WIP tracking for bottom-wear, casualwear, and accessories across multi-channel environments.

Advanced Excel user (pivot tables, VLOOKUP, dashboards) with a data-driven approach to markdowns, replenishment, and sell-through analysis. While OTB management has been implicit within broader category ownership, rapid learning and commercial instinct enable quick formalization of OTB processes for fast-paced fashion cycles.

COMPETENCIES

Assortment Planning	OTB Management	Category Management	Fashion Buying	Vendor Management
Inventory Control	Forecasting	TNA Calendar Tracking	Product Lifecycle Management (PLM)	
Order Tracking	Advanced MS Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Dashboards)		MS Word	Google Sheets
Canva	Meta Ads Manager	SAP (PO/Inventory Tracking - Basic)	Cross-Functional Collaboration	Trend Analysis
Sales Performance Reporting	Catalog & Content Management	E-commerce Marketing	Vendor Negotiation	

EXPERIENCE

Category Manager - Fashion

SuperK, Bangalore, India

Nov 2025 - Present

Built the fashion category from near zero across online channels and a tech-enabled retail network of 3+ co-co stores, launching assortments across apparel, footwear, and accessories while driving vendor expansion, category P&L management, and data-led merchandising decisions.

- Built a women's casualwear category from near zero to 25+ subcategories by onboarding 12+ regional vendors, identifying assortment gaps, and benchmarking against value retailers, delivering ₹3.5 lakh in revenue within two months.
- Negotiated vendor pricing and MOQs to improve product margins from 22% to 35% while maintaining competitive retail pricing, demonstrating commercial acumen in margin optimization.
- Analyzed weekly sales performance and customer demand signals to drive assortment rationalization, improving category gross margin by ~6% and reducing stock-outs by ~20% across priority SKUs.
- Partnered with marketing to launch fashion-led campaigns during key festivals, increasing category visibility by ~22% and driving ~15% uplift in campaign sales.
- Managed 200+ SKUs at Go Colors, improving sell-through by 15% through data-led replenishment and assortment adjustments, and launched 3+ new sub-categories including kids-wear, boosting category sales by 15% in the first quarter.
- Built Excel-based WIP trackers and coordinated with 20+ suppliers across India and Asia, ensuring 95% on-time delivery for seasonal production orders and reducing post-launch return rates to under 10%.

Founder

The Style Gram, Remote - Chennai, India

Nov 2024 - Jun 2025

Built and operated a lean fashion reselling brand focused on affordable women's western-wear, managing end-to-end sourcing, merchandising, content creation, and customer engagement across Instagram and Swiggy Minis.

- Operated a lean fashion brand generating ₹50,000 revenue in launch phase with zero returns, sourcing 60+ SKUs at 45% gross margins and reducing catalog errors by 90% through custom tracking systems.

Assistant Fashion Manager

Go Colors (Go Fashion India Ltd.), Chennai, India

Sept 2020 - June 2023

Supported buying and merchandising for women's and girls' bottom-wear categories including leggings, track pants, formal pants, ethnic bottoms, and shorts, with responsibility for vendor coordination, product lifecycle execution, and data-led assortment decisions.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

EDUCATION

Humber College, Longo School of Business Sept 2023 - Aug 2024

Graduate Certificate in Fashion Management, Toronto, Canada

National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT), Bachelor of Design, Fashion Design July 2016 - July 2020

Chennai, India

SKILLS

Core Competencies	Assortment Planning · OTB Management · Category Management · Fashion Buying · Vendor Management · Inventory Control · Forecasting · TNA Calendar Tracking · Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) · Order Tracking
Tools	Advanced MS Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Dashboards) · MS Word · Google Sheets · Canva · Meta Ads Manager · SAP (PO/Inventory Tracking - Basic)
Functional Strengths	Cross-Functional Collaboration · Trend Analysis · Sales Performance Reporting · Catalog & Content Management · E-commerce Marketing · Vendor Negotiation